a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Cash & Company

TEACHER PD · MODULE 04

Common Misconceptions

Surface. Sharpen. Settle. The 3-step script that works in any band.

The misconception-correction script - how to surface a wrong belief without shaming a kid, sharpen with evidence rather than authority, and settle with a corrected sentence the student says.

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> Correct misconceptions with evidence - not with disapproval.

Module length: ~20 minutes **Activities to do alongside:** Activity 7 (Misconception-Correction Role-Play), Activity 8 (Sensitivity Scenario Sort) **Walkaway move:** a 3-step misconception-correction script that works in any band.

What this module is for

Kids walk into your classroom carrying beliefs about money, business, and work that they absorbed from cartoons, TikTok, parents, older siblings, video games, and the air. Many of those beliefs are wrong. Some of them are deeply wrong. Some are politically charged. Some involve the kid's own family. Your job, as a Cash Certified Teacher, is to surface those beliefs without humiliation and correct them with evidence — not with disapproval.

This module gives you a working script. The script has three steps. The script works in K-2 and in 9-12. It works for "everyone can be rich" and for "my dad says the stock market is rigged" and for "helpers do their job for free." Once you internalize the three steps, you can run a Common Misconceptions correction on any band, any topic, any classroom temperature.

The 3-step misconception-correction script

STEP 1 — SURFACE (WITHOUT JUDGMENT)

You ask a question that invites the misconception to come out into the open. You name what the kids actually believe. You don't moralize. You don't laugh. You don't correct yet.

> **Sample surfacing prompts (band-locked):** - K-2: "What does the helper get for helping?" (likely answer: "They like helping" or "Nothing.") - 3-5: "How much do you think a kid your age could earn in a summer doing yard work?" (you'll get a wide range; some wildly low, some wildly high.) - 6-8: "Who can become a millionaire?" (you'll get "anyone who works hard.") - 9-12: "How important is luck in starting a business?" (you'll get the full spectrum.)

You write the answers down. You thank the students for the honesty. You are not yet teaching anything.

STEP 2 — SHARPEN (WITH EVIDENCE)

You introduce a piece of evidence — a number, a story, a quote, a real-world fact. You let the evidence do the work of complicating the misconception. You don't say "you're wrong"; you say "let's check."

> **Sample sharpening moves:** - K-2: "Let's notice — when the bus driver drives the bus, where does the money come from? The bus company pays them. Helping is their job. They get paid." - 3-5: "Here's a real number. The federal minimum wage in 2025 is $7.25 an hour. Some states are higher. Let's compute: a 10-hour week of yard work at $10/hour..." - 6-8: "In 2023 about 8% of US adults had a net worth over a million dollars. About 1% had over five million. So 'anyone who works hard' isn't quite the whole picture. What might be true instead?" - 9-12: "Two studies on small-business success rates: 50% fail in the first 5 years; the strongest predictor of success after that is... not hard work alone, but customer-evidence quality. What does that suggest about luck vs. moves?"

STEP 3 — SETTLE (WITH A CORRECTED SENTENCE THE STUDENT SAYS)

You don't end by giving the corrected sentence. You ask the student to give it. The misconception is corrected when the student can articulate the corrected version in their own words.

> **Sample settle prompts:** - K-2: "What's the new thing we noticed today? Tell me in one sentence." (Likely: "Helpers get paid for their job.") - 3-5: "If your friend asked you 'how much can a kid earn doing yard work,' what would you say now?" (Likely: "It depends — it's not nothing, but it's not a million.") - 6-8: "Who can become a millionaire — what's the more honest answer?" (Likely: "Some people, with some moves, with some luck.") - 9-12: "How important is luck in starting a business — what's a more careful claim?" (Likely: "Luck matters; the moves matter; you can build the moves; you can't control luck.")

The student says the corrected sentence. You write it on the board next to the original misconception. You leave both there. The visible contrast is the lesson.

Why surface-sharpen-settle works

1. It respects the student. The misconception isn't shameful. It came from somewhere — usually a place the student trusts. Asking "where did you hear that?" is a respectful way to honor the source while complicating the claim.

2. It uses evidence, not authority. A teacher who says "you're wrong" creates a power exchange. A teacher who says "let's check" creates an investigative exchange. The Cash voice prefers the second.

3. It produces a transferable habit. The student leaves the lesson having watched themselves update a belief in response to evidence. That is the most valuable habit Cash to Company teaches. The misconception-correction script is the spine of how that habit is built, week after week.

The most common misconceptions, by band

These are the misconceptions you will encounter. They are listed in order of frequency. Memorize the short corrections. (Full role-play scripts are in the Activity Packet.)

K-2 MISCONCEPTIONS

Misconception	The corrected sentence (Cash voice)
"Helpers help for free."	"Helpers do their job. People pay them. Helping is work."
"The store gives you food."	"The store sells the food. We pay them with money for the food."
"Money grows in the bank."	"The bank holds money for people. People put money in. Then people take it out."
"Mom and Dad have unlimited money." (or the opposite)	(Avoid surfacing this one — see Sensitivity below)
"If I want it, I can have it."	"Sometimes yes. Sometimes no. Wanting is not the same as having."

3-5 MISCONCEPTIONS

Misconception	The corrected sentence (Cash voice)
"If I make something, people will buy it."	"Sometimes. We have to find out who actually wants it."
"Famous people are smart at money."	"Sometimes. Famous people get advice from money helpers. Smart-with-money is a skill, not a side effect of being famous."
"Higher price means better quality."	"Sometimes — and sometimes not. We have to look at the thing itself."
"Working hard means making more."	"Working hard helps. So do other things — what you sell, who you sell to, and luck."
"Banks give you free money."	(Misconception about interest. Correct gently — banks pay you a small amount and charge a larger amount; a topic Grade 5 returns to.)

6-8 MISCONCEPTIONS

Misconception	The corrected sentence (Cash voice)
"Anyone can be a millionaire if they try."	"Some people become millionaires. Trying is part of it. Luck, family resources, geography, and skill are also part of it. The honest answer is: 'some, with conditions.'"
"Side hustles are passive income."	"Most are not passive — they're work. Some make money; many don't. The honest framing is: 'a side venture is a small business with all the same rules.'"
"Buying low, selling high is the secret."	"It's a piece of it. Sourcing, audience, and timing matter more than the slogan."
"Stocks always go up over time."	"On long timescales, US large-cap stocks have trended up. They go down for years at a time. Past performance doesn't guarantee future returns."
"Successful people don't fail."	"Successful people fail more than most — and they collect evidence from each failure. Failure is data, not identity."

9-12 MISCONCEPTIONS

Misconception	The corrected sentence (Cash voice)
"Mindset is the difference."	"Mindset matters. So do skills, capital, luck, network, and structural factors. Mindset alone is not the difference; mindset plus moves plus opportunity is closer."
"Real estate is always a good investment."	"Real estate is sometimes a good investment. It depends on the market, the property, the financing, the holding period, and what alternatives you considered. The slogan is wrong; the analysis is real."
"Crypto is the future of money."	"Crypto is a complex set of technologies. Some uses are real; some are speculative. The Cash answer is: hedge, don't promise. Read the whitepaper. Note who profits from the slogan."
"Taxes are theft." / "Taxes are fair."	(Avoid the political framing — redirect to the technical: "What do taxes fund? Who decides the rate? What does my filing actually require?")
"Quitting is for losers." / "You should quit early."	"Both extremes are slogans. The careful answer is: name the criteria for quitting before you start. Pre-commitment is the move."

The sensitivity rules (locked, non-negotiable)

There are three places Cash never goes. A teacher who follows the misconception-correction script must respect these.

SENSITIVITY RULE 1 — NO FAMILY-MONEY PROBING

Cash never asks: "raise your hand if your family has a savings account." "What does your family budget for groceries?" "Do your parents have credit cards?"

Why: every classroom contains kids whose families would be embarrassed by a public answer. Some kids are food-insecure. Some kids have a parent who recently lost a job. Some kids have a parent who is wealthier than other parents and feels singled out. The probing question is not worth the cost of one kid's shame.

What to do instead: use neutral hypotheticals. - "Imagine a sample family of four. They spend about $250 a week on groceries. Let's work with that number." - "For this exercise, we'll use the federal poverty guideline for a family of three — $24,860 in 2025. That's our 'Sample Family A.'" - "Pick a fictional character — Spider-Man, Hermione Granger, the Pokémon trainer. What do you think their monthly expenses look like?"

Cash neutral hypotheticals work in every band. K-2: "a family who lives in a yellow house." 9-12: "a household earning the median US income — about $74,580 in 2023."

SENSITIVITY RULE 2 — NO GUARANTEED-OUTCOME CLAIMS

Cash never says: "If you do this, you'll get rich." "This will work." "You're going to crush it." "Everyone who tries succeeds."

Why: the program does not promise wealth, and pretending we do is a lie that catches up with us. Some kids will try hard and not get rich. Some kids will start ventures that fail. Some kids will not become entrepreneurs at all. The program is designed to make all of those outcomes okay — clearer thinking is the promise, and clearer thinking happens regardless of outcome.

What to do instead: hedge. Say "probably." Say "in most cases." Say "we expect." Say "if the moves are made, the odds shift." Say "you can't control the outcome; you can control the next move."

SENSITIVITY RULE 3 — NO POLITICS, RELIGION, OR CURRENT EVENTS

Cash never says: "Taxes are too high." "The minimum wage should be $X." "This presidential candidate is good for business." "This religion's view of money is the right one." "Current event Y is unfair."

Why: the program is designed to land in any classroom — Title-I urban, suburban Catholic, rural conservative, suburban progressive. The moment Cash takes a partisan stance, the program loses one of those classrooms. The substance — supply, demand, cost, evidence, customer — is non-partisan. We stay in the substance.

What to do instead: redirect to the technical. "What does the law currently require?" "Who decides this rate, and how does that process work?" "What does the math show?" If a student insists on a partisan answer, validate the question and point to the resource: "That's a real

question. The answer depends on values, not just facts. Let's stick to the facts here, and you can ask your family or your civics teacher about the values part."

Role-play: the sensitivity scenario

A real moment. Read the scene, then the off-script teacher response, then the on-script response.

Scene: It is Grade 6, Week 11, midway through the contribution-margin unit. You are working through a sample lemonade-stand contribution-margin worksheet. A student raises their hand and says: "My mom says she can't afford lemons. Should we change the worksheet so it's cheaper?"

Off-script response (do not do this): "Oh sweetie, I'm sorry. Let's all pretend we have lots of money for the worksheet." (This embarrasses the student. It also moralizes about wealth. It also derails the math.)

On-script response: "Good question. The worksheet uses a sample family — that's everyone in here, no matter what your kitchen actually has. The point of the math is to see how the numbers work, not to match anyone's specific family. Let's keep going. If you want to come up with your own version of the worksheet using fewer lemons, that's a great Capstone Journal entry." (Validates the question. Doesn't probe. Doesn't moralize. Redirects to the math. Offers a productive next step.)

You will get versions of this scene many times in your first year. Practice the script.

The role-play script template (use it in Activity 7)

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1. SURFACE — ask a non-judgmental question that invites the
   misconception out.

2. SHARPEN — introduce one piece of evidence (a number, a story,
   a quote). Say "let's check," not "you're wrong."

3. SETTLE — ask the student to articulate the corrected sentence
   in their own words. Write both versions on the board. Leave
   them there.

   AT EVERY STEP — respect the sensitivity rules. No family-money
   probes. No guaranteed-outcome claims. No politics.
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Module 04 knowledge check

1. State the three steps of the misconception-correction script.

2. Name the three sensitivity rules.
3. A student says "anyone who works hard can be a millionaire." Give the corrected sentence in 6-8 Cash voice.
4. A student says "my mom can't afford lemons." Name what you do NOT do.

Activity tie-ins

- **Activity 7 (Misconception-Correction Role-Play):** In pairs, you are the teacher; partner is the student. Run the 3-step script on three misconceptions provided. Switch roles. Compare to the answer key.
- **Activity 8 (Sensitivity Scenario Sort):** Read 10 classroom scenarios. Sort them: SAFE / SENSITIVITY-RISK / NO-GO. Justify each placement.

Module 04 — answers to the knowledge check

1. Surface (without judgment) → Sharpen (with evidence) → Settle (with a corrected sentence the student says).
2. No family-money probing. No guaranteed-outcome claims. No politics, religion, or current events.
3. (Sample) "Some people become millionaires. Trying is part of it. Luck, family resources, geography, and skill are also part of it. 'Anyone who works hard' isn't the whole picture."
4. You do NOT moralize, you do NOT pity, you do NOT probe further into the family situation. You validate, redirect to the sample-family framing, and offer a productive next step.

One promise.

Correct misconceptions with evidence – not with disapproval.

Cash to Company is built so a curriculum coordinator, a foundation officer, a parent, or a teacher can pick up any one of these strategic references and meet the program at full strength on the first page.

No promise of wealth. No probing of family finances. No partisan content. One question, asked patiently for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

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